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ELECTION 2026 GOVERNOR

‘Happy warrior’ seeks 3rd term

Pritzker runs on his record, but few new plans for Illinois

By Dan Petrella
CHICAGO TRIBUNE

Celebrating his 2022 election victory over southern Illinois lawmaker Darren Bailey and looking ahead to another four years in Springfield, Gov. JB Pritzker claimed the mantle of the “happy warrior.”

The billionaire Democrat has spent much of the past two years emphasizing the “warrior” half of that moniker, long associated with onetime presidential nominee, former Vice President Hubert Humphrey. During the second half of his second term, Pritzker periodically has grabbed the national spotlight as one of the most vocal critics of Republican President Donald Trump’s reprise.

But as early voting opened across all 50 Chicago wards 15 days before this Election Day on Nov. 3, Pritzker reminded a gathering of faith leaders of his “happy” side, the optimistic approach he has taken to addressing the problems facing the state and country.

“We’ve gotten into a bad habit — a bad habit, all of y’all — of spending so much time fretting about what could go wrong that we’ve forgotten to imagine what could go right,” Pritzker told the ecumenical assembly at Evening Star Missionary Baptist Church in the South Side’s Oakland neighborhood. “I’m running for reelection because I believe that things can go right.

“If you work a full-time job, you ought to make enough money with that one job to put food on your table, to see a doctor when you’re sick, to live in a dignified home, to save for retirement, and to take a vacation every once in a while. We can and we ought to make

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Gov. JB Pritzker greets supporters as he arrives for an event for state Senate candidate Michele Clark on Oct. 20. **JOHN J. KIM/TRIBUNE**



EILEEN T. MESLAR/CHICAGO TRIBUNE

FIRST CALL

Ciara Smith, from left, Shana Sumers, Angie Martinez and Anna Bowser react as they watch Game 6 of the WNBA Finals between the Golden State Valkyries and the Atlanta Dream at Babe’s Sports Bar in Chicago on Thursday. The bar opened at 9 a.m. to accommodate the 11:30 a.m. tipoff time. The Dream won 80-69 to force a decisive Game 7.
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Insurance choices for seniors upended

Fewer choices available for Medicare Advantage this enrollment season

By Lisa Schencker
CHICAGO TRIBUNE

A couple of weeks ago, Jeff Anderson and his wife got news that upended their plans for health coverage.

They were told their Medicare Advantage plan was being canceled for next year.

“I looked at it and thought, ‘We’re going to have to change,’” said Anderson, 68, of Libertyville. Anderson and his wife began shopping for a new plan — for the first time since they originally enrolled in Medicare — a process that can sometimes be daunting.

Many seniors across Illinois are finding themselves in a similar situation this open enrollment season, with fewer choices of Medicare Advantage plans and, in some cases, higher costs.

Medicare Advantage plans are Medicare plans offered by private insurers. They appeal to many people because, unlike traditional Medicare, they often offer perks such as dental and vision coverage, and they cap yearly out-of-pocket costs. They also, however, tend to have more limited networks of doctors than traditional Medicare, and may require patients to get prior authorization or referrals for certain services.

In Illinois, about 57% of seniors had traditional Medicare and 43% had Medicare Advantage or a different type of plan in 2024, according to KFF, a nonprofit organization focused on health policy.

For next year, however, the average U.S. senior will have fewer Medicare Advantage plans from which to choose. In Illinois, the average Medicare beneficiary has 30 plans with drug coverage to choose from for next year, compared with 38 plans this year, according to KFF.

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Netanyahu casts doubt on Israeli vote

Party members allege contest ‘stolen’ ahead of tally confirmation

By Cara Anna, Julia Frankel and Koral Saeed
ASSOCIATED PRESS

JERUSALEM — Israeli Prime Minister Benjamin Netanyahu’s party on Thursday amplified unsubstantiated allegations that Arab-led parties had “stolen” the election, potentially with foreign assistance, as final results showed his bloc had lost its majority in parliament.



Netanyahu

The opposition accused Netanyahu of demonizing the Arab population after a historic showing by Arab-led parties in an attempt to delegitimize the emerging results of the election. If the rest of the opposition teams up with Arab parties, a rare and politically risky move, they could potentially form a majority government in parliament, the Knesset.

Results released by election officials late Thursday showed Netanyahu’s bloc winning 53 seats in the 120-member assembly, well below the 68 seats it had controlled at its peak in the previous parlia-

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Golfers putt on a green surrounded by changing leaves on Thursday in Columbus Park in Chicago’s Austin neighborhood. **BRIAN CASSELLA/CHICAGO TRIBUNE**

Halloween forecast mostly a treat

Parents won’t need to worry about frostbite as warm, wet day expected

By Finnegan Belleau
CHICAGO TRIBUNE

Seven years ago, Art Slowinski and two of his children spent most of Halloween driving around in a heated car and looking at decorations instead of trick-or-treating because it was so cold and snowy.

“I do remember spending a great amount of time bundling them up and getting their costumes up and over, because they really wanted to see, let people know what they were,” said Slowinski, who lives in Elmhurst. “And then just going out, and hitting a couple doors, and their noses running, and I think they just kinda felt like they had enough rather quickly.”

The kids only lasted walking about 20 or 30 minutes, he said.

Parents won’t have to worry about frostbite this year. Saturday’s forecast is wet and warm, said Brett Borchardt, senior meteorologist at the National Weather Service.

While Halloween temperatures can vary greatly in Chicago — from 84 degrees in 1950 to 25 in 2019 — experts say the area is likely to see higher temperatures overall in the future due to man-made climate change.

According to Borchardt,

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INSIDE

Bears take a big swing with trade



The Bears on Thursday traded for Titans defensive tackle Jeffery Simmons, a three-time All-Pro and four-time Pro Bowl selection. He will immediately become the centerpiece of the Bears defensive line, which has struggled to find a difference maker at tackle the last several years. **Sports**

FOSTERING CONNECTION: The Chicago Network, a women’s leadership group, launches a new program for earlier-career female professionals. **Business**

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WEATHER FORECAST

TODAY	SAT.	SUN.
H:61 L:52	H:60 L:54	H:66 L:56

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